

Census and Urbanisation

Teaching tables, Confused Pairs, Common Traps, Current Affairs, and other high-yield blocks.

UPPCS + UKPCS Study Library · chapter order follows Subject Notes.

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7 master chapters (chapter map)

Chapter index

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Where a repeated head lives

Head	Home
Census history, methodology, Census 2011 tables, indicators, reports, surveys	1
Growth rate, explosion, Malthus, DTT, optimum population, pop–development–environment	2
Age, sex ratio, literacy, SC/ST, religion, language, rural–urban share, workforce, dependency, UP demography	3
CBR/CDR, TFR, IMR/MMR, life expectancy, NPP 2000, family welfare / RH	4
Migration types / causes / consequences; density; distribution; population geography	5
Urbanisation process, town classes, UA, megacities, slums, Smart Cities / AMRUT, ULBs, 74th	6
World ranks, UN projections, days, books, authors, orgs, leftover one-liners	7
Demographic dividend (growth opportunity teaching)	Economy 8 + age structure here in Topic 3
HDI index depth	Economy 8 / Economy 12; human-development one-line may sit in Topic 3

Status

#	Chapter	Status
1–7	Census → World / misc chapters	Written

Topic 1 — Census and Population Data

Current Affairs

Year	Fact	Why it matters
Rolling	Refresh edition-bound figures from latest Census / Survey / State CA desks.	Do not invent interim totals.

UP district extremes also → [UP Special Topic 6](#). This chapter owns the national Census / demography desk.

Confused Pairs

Confused Pair / Concept A	Confused Pair / Concept B	Trap / Crucial Difference Tested in UPPSC
First Census in Modern India: 1872 (Lord Mayo, non-synchronous)	First Synchronous Decennial Census: 1881 (Lord Ripon, W. C. Plowden)	Trap: If the question asks for the <i>first census</i> , the answer is 1872. If it asks for the <i>first regular/complete decennial synchronous census</i> , the answer is strictly 1881.
National Sex Ratio (Census 2011): 943 (up by 10 from 933)	Child Sex Ratio 0–6 Years (2011): 919 (declined by 8 from 927)	Trap: Overall sex ratio improved, but Child Sex Ratio <i>worsened</i> significantly in 2011. Do not confuse 943 with 919.
Highest SC Percentage State: Punjab (31.9%)	Highest SC Absolute Population State: Uttar Pradesh (4.14 Crore)	Trap: UP has the most SC people in numbers, but Punjab has the highest SC population as a proportion of total state population.
Highest ST Percentage State: Mizoram (94.4%) / Lakshadweep (94.8%)	Highest ST Absolute Population State: Madhya Pradesh (1.53 Crore)	Trap: MP has highest absolute tribal count; Mizoram/Lakshadweep have highest tribal concentration percentage.
States with ZERO Scheduled Tribes: Punjab, Haryana, Delhi, Chandigarh, Puducherry	States with ZERO Scheduled Castes: Nagaland, Mizoram, Meghalaya, Lakshadweep, A&N	Trap: Punjab and Haryana have high SC populations but ZERO STs. Nagaland and Mizoram have high ST populations but ZERO SCs.
UP Highest Literacy District: Gautam Buddha Nagar (80.12%)	UP Highest Female Literacy District: Kanpur Nagar (75.05%)	Trap: GB Nagar is #1 in overall and male literacy, but Kanpur Nagar is #1 in <i>female literacy</i> (GB Nagar female literacy is 70.82%).
UP Highest Sex Ratio District: Jaunpur (1,024)	UP Highest Child Sex Ratio District: Balrampur (950)	Trap: Jaunpur is #1 in overall sex ratio; Balrampur is #1 in 0-6 child sex ratio.
Highest Density State: Bihar (1,106 / km²)	Highest Density UT: Delhi (11,320 / km²)	Trap: In 2001, West Bengal was #1 state in density. In 2011, Bihar surpassed West Bengal to take 1st rank.
Lowest Decadal Growth State: Nagaland (-0.58%)	Second Lowest Decadal Growth State: Kerala (4.91%)	Trap: Nagaland is the only state with negative growth (-0.58%). Kerala has the lowest <i>positive</i> growth among states.
Civil Registration System (CRS): Continuous legal registration of births/deaths	Sample Registration System (SRS): Annual dual-record demographic sample survey	Trap: SRS provides official annual demographic estimates (IMR, TFR, CBR); CRS is administrative civil record registration.

Teaching cards

2.3 Vital Statistics Systems & Alternative Demographic Data Sources

Demographic System / Survey	Operating Agency / Ministry	Core Mandate & Frequency	Key Statistical Indicators Produced
Civil Registration System (CRS)	Office of Registrar General of India (ORGI), MHA	Mandatory continuous legal recording of all vital events under Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969 .	Administrative count of registered births, deaths, stillbirths, and Sex Ratio at Birth (SRB).
Sample Registration System (SRS)	Office of Registrar General of India (ORGI), MHA	Dual-record sample survey operating continuously since 1969–70 .	Official annual baseline for Crude Birth Rate (CBR), Crude Death Rate (CDR), Infant Mortality Rate (IMR), Total Fertility Rate (TFR), and Life Expectancy.
National Family Health Survey (NFHS)	International Institute for Population Sciences (IIPS), Mumbai under MoHFW	Multi-round nationwide sample survey (NFHS-1: 1992-93; NFHS-2: 1998-99; NFHS-3: 2005-06; NFHS-4: 2015-16; NFHS-5: 2019-21).	Maternal and child health, institutional births, immunization, malnutrition, anemia, contraception prevalence, and fertility rates.
Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS)	National Statistical Office (NSO), MoSPI	Continuous annual and quarterly survey (launched April 2017).	Labour force participation rate (LFPR), worker population ratio (WPR), and unemployment rate (UR).

Common Traps

Trap	Correct
Mixing Absolute vs % ranks	Match the stem metric first

Bilingual Terminology — Census and Population Data (जनगणना एवं जनसंख्या डेटा)

English Term	हिंदी पारिभाषिक शब्द	Key Exam Anchor
Census (जनगणना)	जनगणना	Entry 69, Union List; Census Act 1948
Decadal Growth Rate (दशकीय वृद्धि दर)	दशकीय जनसंख्या वृद्धि दर	17.70% (2001–2011)
Population Density (जनसंख्या घनत्व)	जनसंख्या घनत्व	382/km² India; 829/km² UP
Sex Ratio (लिंगानुपात)	लिंगानुपात	943 India; 912 UP (2011)
Child Sex Ratio (बाल लिंगानुपात)	बाल लिंगानुपात (0–6 वर्ष)	919 India; 902 UP (2011)
Literacy Rate (साक्षरता दर)	साक्षरता दर	73.0% India; 67.7% UP (2011)
Scheduled Caste (अनुसूचित जाति)	अनुसूचित जाति (SC)	16.63% of India; UP has largest absolute SC
Scheduled Tribe (अनुसूचित जनजाति)	अनुसूचित जनजाति (ST)	8.61% of India; MP has largest absolute ST
Urbanisation (नगरीकरण)	नगरीकरण / शहरीकरण	31.16% urban (2011); up from 27.81% (2001)
Sample Registration System	नमूना पंजीकरण प्रणाली (SRS)	Official source for CBR, CDR, IMR, TFR
Civil Registration System	नागरिक पंजीकरण प्रणाली (CRS)	Registration of Births & Deaths Act, 1969
Enumerator (गणनाकर्ता)	परिगणक / गणनाकर्ता	Primary Census enumerator = school teacher
Registrar General	महापंजीयक एवं जनगणना आयुक्त	Under MHA; Census 2011 = Dr. C. Chandramouli
De Facto Census	वास्तविक जनगणना	Count where physically present on census night
De Jure Census	विधिक निवास जनगणना	Count at normal/habitual place of residence
Year of Great Divide	महाविभाजन वर्ष	1921 — only negative growth (-0.31%) in Indian census

Extended Theory — Constitutional, Legal and Demographic Framework

2.4 The Census Act, 1948 — Detailed Provisions (Census Act 1948 के विस्तृत प्रावधान)

Section	Provision
Section 3	Power of Central Government to direct a census
Section 4	Appointment of Census Commissioner, Directors, and other officers
Section 5	Duties of local authorities in assisting census operations
Section 8A	Duties of householders to answer questions truthfully
Section 11	Prohibition on canvassing for business in connection with census
Section 13	Penalty for non-cooperation or furnishing false data
Section 15	Confidentiality — individual census data cannot be used in any civil/criminal court against the individual
Section 18	Rule-making power → led to Census Rules, 1990

Topic 2 — Population Growth, Demographic Transition and Theories

Current Affairs

Year	Fact	Why it matters
Rolling	Refresh edition-bound figures from latest Census / Survey / State CA desks.	Do not invent interim totals.

UP district extremes also → [UP Special Topic 6](#). This chapter owns the national Census / demography desk.

Confused Pairs

Confused Pair / Concept A	Confused Pair / Concept B	Trap / Crucial Difference Tested in UPPSC
Malthusian Theory (1798): Subsistence-based, biological food vs population ratio	Optimum Population Theory (1924): Wealth-based, maximum per capita income ratio	Trap: Malthus focused on biological survival (food starvation); Edwin Cannan focused on <i>economic efficiency and highest per capita output</i> .
Stage 2 of DTT (Early Expanding): High Birth Rate + Plummeting Death Rate	Stage 3 of DTT (Late Expanding): Plummeting Birth Rate + Low Death Rate	Trap: Population explosion happens in Stage 2 (India 1951–81). India is currently in Stage 3 (birth rates falling, growth decelerating).
Preventive Checks (Malthus): Voluntary human actions (late marriage, celibacy)	Positive Checks (Malthus): Involuntary natural disasters (famines, plagues, wars)	Trap: Positive does NOT mean good; in Malthusian terminology, positive checks are nature's painful interventions that increase the death rate.
Boserup's Hypothesis: Population pressure causes technological progress	Malthus's Hypothesis: Population growth causes inevitable poverty and collapse	Trap: Boserup is the exact antithesis of Malthus (Boserup: population drives agricultural intensification; Malthus: population causes starvation).
Dalton's Formula: $M = (A - O) / O$ (Overpopulation if $M > 0$)	Dalton's Formula: $M < 0$ (Underpopulation)	Trap: If actual population (A) > optimum (O), M is positive (Overpopulation). If $A < O$, M is negative (Underpopulation).
1921: Year of the Great Divide (Negative growth: -0.31%)	1971: Peak Population Growth Decade (Highest growth: 24.80%)	Trap: 1921 is the Great Divide (shift from stagnant to growing population); 1971 is the historical peak of the population explosion.
Neo-Malthusians (Paul Ehrlich): Advocate modern contraception & abortion	Classical Malthus (1798): Rejected artificial birth control; advocated only moral restraint	Trap: Thomas Malthus was a clergyman who opposed artificial contraception; Neo-Malthusians actively promote technological birth control.
Replacement Level Fertility (TFR = 2.1)	Current India TFR (NFHS-5: 2.0)	Trap: India's TFR has already dropped below replacement level (2.0) nationally, though population will continue growing due to <i>demographic momentum</i> .
Exponential (J-shaped) Growth: Unchecked growth with constant birth/death rates	Logistic (S-shaped) Growth: Growth slowed by carrying capacity (K)	Trap: Real populations in nature follow the S-shaped logistic curve due to environmental resistance.
Demographic Dividend: High ratio of working-age (15–59) to dependents	Demographic Disaster / Drag: High working-age population without jobs/skills	Trap: Dividend is only potential; if uneducated and unemployed, the dividend turns into a demographic liability/drag.

Common Traps

Trap	Correct
Mixing Absolute vs % ranks	Match the stem metric first

Bilingual Terminology — Population Growth and Demographic Transition (जनसंख्या वृद्धि एवं जनांकिकीय संक्रमण)

English Term	हिंदी पारिभाषिक शब्द	Key Anchor
Demographic Transition Theory	जनांकिकीय संक्रमण सिद्धांत	W.S. Thompson (1929), Frank Notestein (1945)
Crude Birth Rate (CBR)	अपरिष्कृत जन्म दर	Births per 1,000 mid-year population
Crude Death Rate (CDR)	अपरिष्कृत मृत्यु दर	Deaths per 1,000 mid-year population
Total Fertility Rate (TFR)	कुल प्रजनन दर	Avg children per woman over reproductive life
Infant Mortality Rate (IMR)	शिशु मृत्यु दर	Deaths under 1 year per 1,000 live births
Maternal Mortality Rate (MMR)	मातृ मृत्यु अनुपात	Maternal deaths per 1,00,000 live births
Natural Increase	स्वाभाविक वृद्धि	CBR minus CDR
Replacement Level Fertility	प्रतिस्थापन स्तरीय प्रजनन	TFR ~2.1 for population stabilization
Demographic Dividend	जनांकिकीय लाभांश	Economic benefit of rising working-age proportion
Dependency Ratio	निर्भरता अनुपात	$(0-14 + 65+) / (15-64) \times 100$
Population Momentum	जनसंख्या गति / संवेग	Growth continues even after TFR falls to replacement level
Malthusian Theory	माल्थस का जनसंख्या सिद्धांत	Population grows geometrically; food arithmetically
Optimum Population Theory	इष्टतम जनसंख्या सिद्धांत	Population level maximizing per capita output
Life Expectancy at Birth	जन्म के समय जीवन प्रत्याशा	Average years a newborn is expected to live

Extended Theory — Demographic Transition Stages (जनांकिकीय संक्रमण की अवस्थाएँ)

Population Theories — Comparative Overview

Theory / Theorist	Core Idea	Criticism	India Relevance
Malthus (1798) — <i>Essay on Population</i>	Population grows geometrically (2,4,8...); food grows arithmetically (2,4,6...). Positive checks (war, famine, disease) and preventive checks (celibacy, late marriage) regulate population.	Does not account for technological advances in food production; ignores demographic transition.	Malthusian fears were valid in pre-green-revolution India; less applicable post-1965.
Optimum Population Theory (Cannan, Carr-Saunders)	An optimum population exists for each resource level, maximizing per-capita output. Under-population and over-population both reduce output.	“Optimum” is dynamic and impossible to measure precisely.	Concept used in National Population Policy formulation.
Demographic Transition Theory (Thompson/Notestein)	Societies pass through 4 stages of birth/death rate changes as they develop economically.	Cannot predict timing; assumes uniform development pathways across all societies.	India is transitioning from Stage 2 to Stage 3; some States (Kerala, TN) already at Stage 3.
Theory of Demographic Dividend	When working-age (15–64) population rises relative to dependents, savings, investment, and growth can accelerate	Dividend requires investment in health, education and job creation to be realized	India’s demographic dividend window: ~2020–2050. Requires skill development.

Topic 3 — Population Composition and Demographic Characteristics

Current Affairs

Year	Fact	Why it matters
Rolling	Refresh edition-bound figures from latest Census / Survey / State CA desks.	Do not invent interim totals.

UP district extremes also → [UP Special Topic 6](#). This chapter owns the national Census / demography desk.

Confused Pairs

Confused Pair / Concept A	Confused Pair / Concept B	Trap / Crucial Difference Tested in UPPSC
Highest Overall Sex Ratio State: Kerala (1,084)	Highest Child Sex Ratio State (0–6): Mizoram (970) / Meghalaya	Trap: Kerala is #1 in overall sex ratio, but Mizoram/Meghalaya are #1 in Child Sex Ratio (Kerala child sex ratio is 964).
Highest SC Concentration (%): Punjab (31.9%)	Highest SC Absolute Numbers: Uttar Pradesh (4.14 Crore)	Trap: Do not confuse percentage with absolute population. Punjab has highest %; UP has highest absolute head count.
Highest ST Concentration (%): Mizoram (94.4%) / Lakshadweep (94.8%)	Highest ST Absolute Numbers: Madhya Pradesh (1.53 Crore)	Trap: MP has the most tribal citizens; Mizoram and Lakshadweep have the highest tribal percentage share.
Highest Literacy Religious Group: Jains (94.9%)	Highest Sex Ratio Religious Group: Christians (1,023)	Trap: Jains are #1 in literacy; Christians are #1 in sex ratio (1,023 females per 1000 males). Sikhs have lowest sex ratio (903).
Main Worker: Worked for ≥ 183 days (6 months) in reference year	Marginal Worker: Worked for < 183 days in reference year	Trap: The exact threshold is 183 days (or 6 months). Working even 182 days classifies a person as a marginal worker.
Crude Literacy Rate:		
$\frac{\text{Total Literates}}{\text{Total Population}} \times 100$	Effective Literacy Rate:	
$\frac{\text{Total Literates (7+)}}{\text{Population Aged 7+}} \times 100$	Trap: Standard official literacy in India is always the <i>Effective Literacy Rate</i> (excluding infants 0–6 years).	
Lowest Female Literacy State: Rajasthan (52.1%)	Lowest Overall Literacy State: Bihar (61.8%)	Trap: Bihar has the lowest overall and male literacy, but Rajasthan has the lowest <i>female</i> literacy and widest gender gap (27.1%).
2nd Most Spoken Language in India: Bengali (8.03%)	3rd Most Spoken Language in India: Marathi (6.86%)	Trap: In 2001, Telugu was 3rd. In 2011, Marathi surpassed Telugu (6.70%) to become the 3rd most spoken language.
UP Highest Overall Literacy: Gautam Buddha Nagar (80.12%)	UP Highest Female Literacy: Kanpur Nagar (75.05%)	Trap: GB Nagar is highest overall, but Kanpur Nagar is highest in female literacy.
Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs): 75 Groups in 18 States & 1 UT	Total Notified Scheduled Tribes: Over 705 Distinct Tribes	Trap: 75 is the number of PVTGs (Dhebar Commission); total scheduled tribes exceed 700.

Common Traps

Trap	Correct
Mixing Absolute vs % ranks	Match the stem metric first

Bilingual Terminology — Population Composition (जनसंख्या संरचना)

English Term	हिंदी पारिभाषिक शब्द	Key Anchor
Age-Sex Pyramid	आयु-लिंग पिरामिड	Graphical representation of population age-sex structure
Working Age Population	कार्यशील आयु जनसंख्या	15–64 years; basis of demographic dividend
Dependency Ratio	निर्भरता अनुपात	Young (0–14) + Old (65+) / Working age (15–64)
Main Workers	मुख्य श्रमिक	Worked ≥ 183 days in reference year
Marginal Workers	सीमांत श्रमिक	Worked < 183 days in reference year
Non-Workers	अश्रमिक	Did not work at all during reference year
Cultivators	कृषक	Engaged in agricultural cultivation on own/leased land
Agricultural Labourers	कृषि श्रमिक	Work on others' land for wages/share of crop
Household Industry Workers	गृह उद्योग श्रमिक	Work in cottage industries within or adjacent to household
Other Workers	अन्य श्रमिक	All workers not in above three categories
Religious Minority	धार्मिक अल्पसंख्यक	Non-majority religious communities; 6 notified minorities in India
Scheduled Caste (अनुसूचित जाति)	SC	Article 341 — Presidential notification
Scheduled Tribe (अनुसूचित जनजाति)	ST	Article 342 — Presidential notification
Worker Participation Rate	श्रमिक सहभागिता दर	Percentage of workers in total population

Extended Theory — Worker Classification System (Census 2011)

Religious Composition of India — Census 2011

Religion	Population (%)	Key Concentration States
Hinduism	79.8%	Himachal Pradesh (95.2%), Odisha, Chhattisgarh
Islam	14.2%	J&K, Assam, West Bengal, Kerala, UP
Christianity	2.3%	Nagaland (87.9%), Mizoram (87.2%), Meghalaya (74.6%)
Sikhism	1.7%	Punjab (57.7%)
Buddhism	0.7%	Sikkim, Arunachal Pradesh, Ladakh
Jainism	0.4%	Gujarat, Rajasthan, Maharashtra
Other / Not Stated	0.9%	Various

Topic 4 — Fertility, Mortality, Health and Population Policies

Current Affairs

Year	Fact	Why it matters
Rolling	Refresh edition-bound figures from latest Census / Survey / State CA desks.	Do not invent interim totals.

UP district extremes also → [UP Special Topic 6](#). This chapter owns the national Census / demography desk.

Confused Pairs

Confused Pair / Concept A	Confused Pair / Concept B	Trap / Crucial Difference Tested in UPPSC
Infant Mortality Rate (IMR): Deaths under 1 year per 1,000 Live Births	Maternal Mortality Ratio (MMR): Maternal deaths per 100,000 (1 Lakh) Live Births	Trap: The most common unit trap in competitive exams! IMR denominator is 1,000; MMR denominator is strictly 100,000 (1 Lakh).
Gross Reproduction Rate (GRR): Daughters born ignoring mortality	Net Reproduction Rate (NRR): Daughters surviving to adulthood accounting for mortality	Trap: NRR is always less than or equal to GRR because NRR discounts for female child mortality. NRR = 1.0 means exact replacement.
Crude Birth Rate (CBR): Total births per 1,000 total population	General Fertility Rate (GFR): Total births per 1,000 women aged 15–49	Trap: CBR denominator is the entire population (including men and children); GFR denominator is strictly women in reproductive age.
NPP 2000 Medium-Term Goal: TFR 2.1 by 2010	NPP 2000 Long-Term Goal: Population stabilization by 2045	Trap: Do not mix up the milestone years: 2010 was for TFR 2.1; 2045 was for total population stabilization.
National Commission on Population: Chaired by the Prime Minister	State Population Commission: Chaired by the Chief Minister	Trap: NCP is chaired by the Prime Minister (not the Union Health Minister).
Janani Suraksha Yojana (JSY, 2005): Cash assistance for institutional delivery	Janani Shishu Suraksha Karyakram (JSSK, 2011): 100% cashless, zero-expense deliveries	Trap: JSY provides cash incentives (Rs 1,400 rural); JSSK eliminates all out-of-pocket expenses (free drugs, tests, transport, c-section).
Neonatal Mortality (NMR): Deaths within first 28 days of life	Infant Mortality (IMR): Deaths within first 1 year (365 days) of life	Trap: NMR is a subset of IMR. Neonatal deaths account for over 70% of all infant deaths in India.
National Health Mission (NHM): Integrates NRHM (2005) + NUHM (2013)	Ayushman Bharat (2018): Integrates HWCs + PM-JAY	Trap: NHM is the overarching health system architecture; Ayushman Bharat is the flagship assurance & wellness scheme.
Lowest TFR State: Sikkim (1.1)	Highest TFR State: Bihar (3.0)	Trap: Sikkim has the lowest TFR in India (1.1), far below replacement. Bihar is the highest (3.0).
SDG Target 3.1 for MMR: Less than 70 per 100,000 live births by 2030	Current India MMR (SRS 2018–20): 97 per 100,000 live births	Trap: India has reduced MMR from 130 to 97, and is on track to achieve the SDG target of < 70 by 2030.

Common Traps

Trap	Correct
Mixing Absolute vs % ranks	Match the stem metric first

Bilingual Terminology — Fertility, Mortality, Health and Population Policy (प्रजनन, मृत्यु दर, स्वास्थ्य एवं जनसंख्या नीति)

English Term	हिंदी पारिभाषिक शब्द	Key Anchor
Family Planning	परिवार नियोजन	India: world's first national Family Planning Programme (1952)
National Population Policy	राष्ट्रीय जनसंख्या नीति	NPP 2000; target TFR 2.1 by 2010
Total Fertility Rate (TFR)	कुल प्रजनन दर (TFR)	India TFR ~2.0 (SRS 2020)
Contraceptive Prevalence Rate	गर्भनिरोधक प्रसार दर	CPR — % women using contraception
Infant Mortality Rate (IMR)	शिशु मृत्यु दर	Deaths under 1 yr per 1,000 live births; India ≈ 28 (SRS 2020)
Neonatal Mortality Rate	नवजात मृत्यु दर	Deaths in first 28 days per 1,000 live births
Maternal Mortality Ratio (MMR)	मातृ मृत्यु अनुपात	Deaths per 1,00,000 live births; India ≈ 103 (2017–19)
Under-Five Mortality Rate	5 वर्ष से कम मृत्यु दर (U5MR)	Deaths under 5 years per 1,000 live births
Stillbirth	मृत शिशु जन्म	Baby born dead after 28 weeks of pregnancy
Sex Ratio at Birth (SRB)	जन्म के समय लिंगानुपात	Reflects female foeticide; declining trend in India
Age-Specific Fertility Rate	आयु-विशेष प्रजनन दर	Births per 1,000 women in specific age group
Life Expectancy	जीवन प्रत्याशा	India ≈ 69.7 years (2015–19 SRS)
Mission Parivar Vikas	Mission Parivar Vikas	MOHFW scheme for high-TFR districts
ASHA	मान्यता प्राप्त सामाजिक स्वास्थ्य कार्यकर्ता	Accredited Social Health Activist under NHM

Extended Theory — Population Policy History of India (भारत की जनसंख्या नीति का इतिहास)

NFHS-5 Key Findings (2019–21) vs NFHS-4 (2015–16)

Indicator	NFHS-4 (2015–16)	NFHS-5 (2019–21)	Trend
TFR	2.2	2.0	↓ Below replacement level
IMR	40.7	35.2	↓ Improving
U5MR	49.7	41.9	↓ Improving
Stunted children (< 5 yrs)	38.4%	35.5%	↓ Improving
Wasted children	21.0%	19.3%	↓ Improving
Anaemia (women 15–49)	53.0%	57.0%	↑ WORSENING
Institutional births	78.9%	88.6%	↑ Improving
CPR (Modern methods)	47.8%	56.5%	↑ Improving
Women with ≥ 10 yrs education	35.7%	41.0%	↑ Improving

Topic 5 — Migration and Population Distribution

Current Affairs

Year	Fact	Why it matters
Rolling	Refresh edition-bound figures from latest Census / Survey / State CA desks.	Do not invent interim totals.

UP district extremes also → [UP Special Topic 6](#). This chapter owns the national Census / demography desk.

Confused Pairs

Confused Pair / Concept A	Confused Pair / Concept B	Trap / Crucial Difference Tested in UPPSC
Arithmetic Density:		
$\frac{\text{Total Population}}{\text{Total Land Area}}$	Physiological Density:	
$\frac{\text{Total Population}}{\text{Net Cultivated Arable Land Area}}$	Trap: Arithmetic density uses <i>total</i> geographical area; physiological density uses only <i>arable / cultivated</i> land area. Physiological density is always much higher than arithmetic density.	
Highest Out-Migration State: Uttar Pradesh (Origin)	Highest In-Migration State: Maharashtra (Destination)	Trap: UP is the #1 state where migrants <i>leave from</i> ; Maharashtra (Mumbai/Pune) is the #1 state where migrants <i>arrive at</i> .
Largest Migration Stream (Overall): Rural to Rural (Female dominated)	Largest Migration Stream for Economic Jobs: Rural to Urban (Male dominated)	Trap: Overall migration is dominated by Rural to Rural (due to marriage). Employment-seeking migration is dominated by Rural to Urban.
Primary Reason for Female Migration: Marriage (66.7%)	Primary Reason for Male Migration: Work / Employment (38%)	Trap: Two-thirds of women migrate due to marriage; over one-third of men migrate for employment.
Ravenstein's Law of Migration (1885): Empirical rules of distance & gender	Everett Lee's Model of Migration (1966): Push-Pull factors & intervening obstacles	Trap: Ravenstein discovered migration laws (short distance, female short-distance dominance); Everett Lee formalized Push-Pull factors.
Highest Density State in 2001: West Bengal (903 / km ²)	Highest Density State in 2011: Bihar (1,106 / km ²)	Trap: Bihar surpassed West Bengal in Census 2011 to take the 1st rank in density among States.
Ghost Villages (Almora & Pauri Garhwal): Mountainous out-migration	Urban Congestion (Ghaziabad & Delhi): Destination in-migration pressure	Trap: Almora and Pauri Garhwal in Uttarakhand recorded <i>negative</i> decadal growth due to extreme out-migration.
Intra-District Migration: Within the same district (62% of migrants)	Inter-State Migration: Across different States (12% of migrants)	Trap: The vast majority of migration in India is local and intra-district, not inter-state.
Agricultural Density:		
$\frac{\text{Agricultural Workers}}{\text{Net Cultivated Area}}$	Agricultural Population Density: Total farm household members on arable land	Trap: Agricultural density measures the ratio of farm workers to farm land; high agricultural density indicates agricultural overcrowding and low labour productivity.
One Nation One Ration Card (ONORC): Domestic food ration portability	e-Shram Portal: National database of unorganized & migrant labour	Trap: ONORC provides food grain portability across PDS ration shops; e-Shram is a digital registry issuing 12-digit UAN numbers.

Common Traps

Trap	Correct
Mixing Absolute vs % ranks	Match the stem metric first

Bilingual Terminology – Migration and Population Distribution

English Term	Hindi Term	Key Anchor
Migration (प्रवास)	प्रवास	Movement from place of origin to destination
In-Migration (आंतरिक अंतःप्रवास)	अंतःप्रवास	Moving INTO a place/region from elsewhere within country
Out-Migration (बाह्यप्रवास)	बाह्यप्रवास	Moving OUT OF a place/region to elsewhere within country
Immigration (आप्रवास)	अप्रवासन	Entering a country from another country
Emigration (उत्प्रवास)	उत्प्रवासन	Leaving one’s country to settle in another
Refugee (शरणार्थी)	शरणार्थी	Person forced to flee due to persecution, conflict
Internally Displaced Person (IDP)	आंतरिक रूप से विस्थापित व्यक्ति	Displaced within national boundaries; not crossing borders
Brain Drain (प्रतिभा पलायन)	प्रतिभा पलायन	Migration of skilled/educated people from developing to developed countries
Remittances (प्रेषण)	प्रेषण/विप्रेषण	Money sent by migrants to home country/family
Push Factors (बाहर धकेलने वाले कारक)	प्रतिकर्षण कारक	Factors forcing people to leave origin (poverty, drought, unemployment)
Pull Factors (खींचने वाले कारक)	अपकर्षण कारक	Factors attracting migrants to destination (jobs, facilities, education)
Seasonal Migration (मौसमी प्रवास)	मौसमी प्रवास	Short-term movement driven by agricultural seasons
Circular Migration (चक्रीय प्रवास)	चक्रीय प्रवास	Regular to-and-fro migration between rural and urban areas
Net Migration	शुद्ध प्रवास	In-migration minus out-migration for a given area
Ravenstein’s Laws of Migration	रेवेन्स्टीन के प्रवास नियम	Foundational rules: most migrants move short distances; migration proceeds step-by-step

Extended Theory – Migration: Types, Causes, and India’s Patterns

India’s Migration Patterns (Census 2011)

Migration Category	Key Facts (Census 2011)
Total Migrants (lifetime)	~45.36 crore (~37% of total population)
Dominant stream	Rural to Rural (most common – marriage-driven, esp. women)
Fastest growing stream	Rural to Urban (economic migration for employment)
Maharashtra	Largest in-migration State – Mumbai’s pull
Delhi (NCT)	Highest inter-state in-migration (relative density)
Uttar Pradesh	Largest source State of out-migrants
Bihar	2nd largest source State of out-migrants

Migration Category	Key Facts (Census 2011)
Rajasthan	Major labour out-migration to Gujarat, Maharashtra
Kerala	Highest remittance-receiving State from Gulf countries
Major causes in UP	Lack of employment in eastern UP; agrarian distress; seasonal farm labour
Reverse migration	During COVID-19 (2020): ~1 crore migrants returned to UP and Bihar

Topic 6 — Urbanisation and Urban Development

Current Affairs

Year	Fact	Why it matters
Rolling	Refresh edition-bound figures from latest Census / Survey / State CA desks.	Do not invent interim totals.

UP district extremes also → [UP Special Topic 6](#). This chapter owns the national Census / demography desk.

Confused Pairs

Confused Pair / Concept A	Confused Pair / Concept B	Trap / Crucial Difference Tested in UPPSC
Statutory Town: Created by State statute/law (4,041 towns)	Census Town: Defined by 3 demographic ratios (3,894 towns)	Trap: A Census Town is NOT a statutory municipality; it is legally administered by a Gram Panchayat despite having urban demographics.
Class I Town (City): Population $\geq 100,000$ ext{ (1 Lakh+)}	Metropolitan City / UA: Population $\geq 1,000,000$ ext{ (10 Lakh+)}	Trap: Do not confuse City (1 Lakh+) with Metropolitan City (10 Lakh+). Class I has 468 cities; Million-plus has 53 cities.
Most Urbanised State (%): Goa (62.2%)	Most Urbanised State (Absolute Population): Maharashtra (5.08 Crore)	Trap: Goa is #1 in urban percentage; Maharashtra is #1 in absolute urban headcount (UP is 2nd in numbers).
District Planning Committee (DPC - Art 243ZD): At least 4/5th (80%) elected	Metropolitan Planning Committee (MPC - Art 243ZE): At least 2/3rd (66.7%) elected	Trap: DPC requires 4/5th elected members; MPC requires 2/3rd elected members from municipalities and panchayats.
Wards Committee Mandate (Article 243S): Population ≥ 3 ext{ Lakh}	Metropolitan Area Definition (Article 243P): Population ≥ 10 ext{ Lakh}	Trap: Wards committees are mandatory at 3 Lakh; Metropolitan planning committees at 10 Lakh.
Smart Cities Mission (100 Cities): SPV model, pan-city ICT solutions	AMRUT Mission (500 Cities): Basic civic infrastructure (tap water, sewerage, drains)	Trap: Smart Cities focused on 100 selected cities with SPVs; AMRUT focused on 500 cities for basic universal water and sewage coverage.
Primate City Concept: Mark Jefferson (1939)	Rank-Size Rule: George Zipf (1949)	Trap: Jefferson = Primate City; Zipf = Rank-Size Rule; Patrick Geddes = Conurbation (1915); Jean Gottmann = Megalopolis (1961).
UP Most Urbanised District (%): Ghaziabad (67.6%)	UP Most Populous City (Corporation): Kanpur Nagar	Trap: Ghaziabad is the most urbanised district by percentage; Kanpur is the largest city by municipal population in UP.
Census Slum Threshold: Minimum 300 people or 60–70 households	Highest Slum Population State: Maharashtra (1.18 Crore)	Trap: 300 persons is the census identification threshold; Maharashtra has the most slum dwellers.
73rd Amendment (Panchayats): Part IX, 11th Schedule (29 items)	74th Amendment (Municipalities): Part IX-A, 12th Schedule (18 items)	Trap: 11th Schedule has 29 items (Panchayats); 12th Schedule has 18 items (Municipalities).

Common Traps

Trap	Correct
Mixing Absolute vs % ranks	Match the stem metric first

Bilingual Terminology – Urbanisation and Urban Development

English Term	Hindi Term	Key Anchor
Urbanisation (नगरीकरण)	नगरीकरण / शहरीकरण	Process of population shift from rural to urban areas
Urban Agglomeration (UA)	नगरीय संकुल	Continuous urban spread beyond one city's municipal limit
Census Town	जनगणना नगर	5,000+ pop; 75%+ male non-agri workers; density 400+/km ²
Statutory Town	विधिक/वैधानिक नगर	Notified by State law (municipality, cantonment, notified area)
Metropolitan City	महानगर	Population 10 lakh (1 million) and above
Million-Plus City	दस लाख से अधिक जनसंख्या वाला शहर	26 such cities in India (Census 2011)
Primate City	प्रमुख नगर	Disproportionately large city dominating a country/region
Slum (झुग्गी-बस्ती)	मलिन बस्ती / झुग्गी-झोपड़ी	Residential area lacking basic services; low-quality housing
Counter-urbanisation	प्रति-नगरीकरण	Population movement from cities back to smaller towns/rural areas
Suburbanisation	उपनगरीकरण	Growth of areas on city outskirts (suburbs)
Urban Sprawl	नगरीय प्रसार	Uncontrolled expansion of city into surrounding areas
Smart City	स्मार्ट सिटी	Technology-driven, citizen-centric sustainable urban development
AMRUT	AMRUT (अटल मिशन कायाकल्प एवं नगर परिवर्तन)	Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation
PMAY-Urban	प्रधानमंत्री आवास योजना (शहरी)	Housing for All scheme targeting urban homeless
Urban Local Body (ULB)	शहरी स्थानीय निकाय	Municipal bodies governing urban areas (Article 243P-243ZG)

Extended Theory – Urban Classification and Urbanisation in India

Million-Plus Cities in India (Census 2011) – Top 10

Rank	City / UA	Population (in Lakh)
1	Mumbai (Greater Mumbai UA)	184.14
2	Delhi	163.14
3	Kolkata	141.12
4	Chennai	86.53
5	Bengaluru	84.26
6	Hyderabad	77.49
7	Ahmedabad	63.57
8	Pune	50.57
9	Surat	44.62
10	Jaipur	30.73

Key Urban Schemes (नगरीय योजनाएँ)

Scheme	Full Name	Year	Key Target
JNNURM	Jawaharlal Nehru National Urban Renewal Mission	2005	Infrastructure and governance in 65 mission cities
AMRUT	Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation	2015	Basic services (water, sanitation) in 500 cities
Smart Cities Mission	Smart Cities Mission	2015	100 smart cities; technology integration
PMAY-U	PM Awas Yojana (Urban) – Housing for All	2015	Affordable housing for urban poor by 2022
SBM-U	Swachh Bharat Mission (Urban)	2014	Open defecation-free (ODF) urban areas
HRIDAY	Heritage City Development and Augmentation Yojana	2015	Preservation of 12 heritage cities
RERA	Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act	2016	Consumer protection in real estate sector

Topic 7 — World Population and Demographic Misc

Current Affairs

Year	Fact	Why it matters
Rolling	Refresh edition-bound figures from latest Census / Survey / State CA desks.	Do not invent interim totals.

UP district extremes also → [UP Special Topic 6](#). This chapter owns the national Census / demography desk.

Confused Pairs

Confused Pair / Concept A	Confused Pair / Concept B	Trap / Crucial Difference Tested in UPPSC
World Population Day: 11 July (Commemorates 5 Billion in 1987)	World Health Day: 7 April (Commemorates WHO founding 1948)	Trap: Highly tested date pair. 11 July is Population Day; 7 April is Health Day.
National Youth Day (India): 12 January (Swami Vivekananda)	International Youth Day: 12 August (United Nations)	Trap: Note the difference: 12 January is National; 12 August is International.
National Consumer Day (India): 24 December (Presidential assent to CPA 1986)	World Consumer Rights Day: 15 March (JFK historic address)	Trap: 24 December is National Consumer Day; 15 March is World Consumer Rights Day.
1974 Bucharest Conference: "Development is the best contraceptive"	1994 Cairo Conference (ICPD): Rights-based reproductive health & gender equality	Trap: Bucharest 1974 focused on macro development; Cairo 1994 transformed policy into individual reproductive rights.
UNFPA: Publishes <i>State of World Population (SWOP)</i> report	UN Population Division (UN DESA): Publishes <i>World Population Prospects (WPP)</i>	Trap: SWOP = UNFPA; WPP = UN DESA Population Division.
Most Populous Country: India (~1.435 Billion)	Second Most Populous Country: China (~1.419 Billion)	Trap: India officially overtook China in 2023. Any outdated question listing China as #1 is obsolete.
Most Densely Populated Sovereign State: Monaco (~26,000 / km²)	Most Densely Populated Major Country (>10M): Bangladesh (~1,160 / km²)	Trap: Monaco is a city-state; Bangladesh is the most densely populated large nation.
Least Densely Populated Country: Mongolia (~2.1 / km²)	Least Densely Populated Island Territory: Greenland (0.03 / km²)	Trap: Mongolia is the least dense sovereign country; Greenland is an autonomous territory.
IIPS (International Institute for Population Sciences): Mumbai	NIMS (National Institute of Medical Statistics): New Delhi	Trap: IIPS is located in Deonar, Mumbai; NIMS (ICMR) is in New Delhi.
UN-Habitat Headquarters: Nairobi, Kenya	UNFPA Headquarters: New York, USA	Trap: UN-Habitat is in Nairobi (along with UNEP); UNFPA and UNICEF are in New York.

Common Traps

Trap	Correct
Mixing Absolute vs % ranks	Match the stem metric first

Bilingual Terminology – World Population and Demographic Miscellaneous

English Term	Hindi Term	Key Anchor
World Population Day	विश्व जनसंख्या दिवस	11 July (since 1989; UNFPA initiative)

English Term	Hindi Term	Key Anchor
UNFPA	संयुक्त राष्ट्र जनसंख्या कोष	United Nations Population Fund; HQ: New York
World Population Report	विश्व जनसंख्या रिपोर्ट	Published annually by UNFPA
World Bank Development Report	विश्व बैंक विकास रिपोर्ट	Annual; covers development themes including demographics
Human Development Index (HDI)	मानव विकास सूचकांक	UNDP; GNI/capita + Life expectancy + Education
Gender Development Index (GDI)	लिंग विकास सूचकांक	HDI disaggregated by gender
Gender Inequality Index (GII)	लिंग असमानता सूचकांक	UNDP; reproductive health + empowerment + labour
Population Clock	जनसंख्या घड़ी	Real-time world population counter (UN/US Census Bureau)
Demographic Bonus	जनांकिकीय बोनस	Synonym for Demographic Dividend
Ageing Population	वृद्ध होती जनसंख्या	Rising proportion of elderly (65+) in total population
Greying of Population	जनसंख्या का बुजुर्ग होना	Increasing median age due to declining fertility and mortality
Zero Population Growth	शून्य जनसंख्या वृद्धि	Birth rate equals death rate; TFR at exact replacement level
Negative Population Growth	ऋणात्मक जनसंख्या वृद्धि	Deaths exceed births; population declines
World's Most Populous Country	विश्व का सर्वाधिक जनसंख्या वाला देश	India (~April 2023 surpassed China)

Extended Theory – World Population Dynamics

Top 10 Most Populous Countries (2023 Estimates)

Rank	Country	Population (approx.)
1	India	~1.43 Billion
2	China	~1.41 Billion
3	USA	~340 Million
4	Indonesia	~278 Million
5	Pakistan	~240 Million
6	Brazil	~216 Million
7	Nigeria	~220 Million
8	Bangladesh	~170 Million
9	Russia	~145 Million
10	Ethiopia	~125 Million

Key International Organisations in Demography

Organisation	Full Form	Key Demographic Function
UNFPA	United Nations Population Fund	Annual World Population Report; family planning support
UN DESA	UN Department of Economic and Social Affairs	World Population Prospects (biennial)
WHO	World Health Organization	Global health statistics, mortality data
World Bank	International Bank for Reconstruction & Development	World Development Indicators; WDR
ILO	International Labour Organization	Labour force statistics, employment data
UNDP	UN Development Programme	HDI, GII, GDI rankings

India in World Demographic Context

Parameter	India's Position	Key Note
Population	1st (surpassed China ~April 2023)	UN World Population Prospects 2022
Area	7th largest country by area	2.4% of world's land area
Population Density	Among highest globally	382/km2 vs world avg ~60/km2
TFR	Below replacement level (~2.0)	First time in India's history
Working-age population	Largest in world	Demographic dividend advantage